

BIRCHRIGHTS

Song of Beckoning — This potent song has a hypnotic effect on any who hear it, causing them to seek out the source of the song. The player must roll Charisma + Performance (difficulty 7), resisted by the target's Willpower (difficulty 7). Anyone who is affected by the Song is compelled to find the pu'gwis and remain in her presence without taking action until the spell is broken. Once in the presence of the pu'gwis, anyone under the effect of the Song can attempt another Willpower roll once per minute to break its effect. If the pu'gwis takes any violent action, or if anyone attacks the target, the effect is immediately broken.

Song of Dismissal — This power allows the pu'gwis to remove all memories of herself from the minds of those who hear it. It is most often used on humans who are frightened by the pu'gwis and allowed to return to civilization, though it can be used on anyone the pu'gwis desires. The player rolls Charisma + Performance (difficulty 7), resisted by the target's Willpower (difficulty 7).

FRAILTIES

Decay — All pu'gwis have an Appearance of 0 in their fae mien (and 1 in their mortal seeming), which can never be raised. Also, pu'gwis can never have a Strength rating above 3.

"Please stay and talk for a while. I would cherish even a little of your time."

Rock Giants

Iroquois and Seneca legends of rock giants feature them in the role of terrible cannibalistic foes, who wreak great havoc and destruction on all they encounter. Yet other tales tell of kindly giants who might befriend a worthy warrior by fighting alongside him against all enemies — even to the death.

Eating and fighting are the true passions of the rock giants. They are slow to make friends but fiercely loyal. Once a rock giant's friendship is earned, it is forever. Modern rock giants can be found in occupations that allow them to make use of their physical prowess: construction workers, prize fighters, and sometimes bodyguards. They come from a matrilineal society where the females are trained, as soon as they are discovered, to be leaders. Men hold leadership positions as well, but the resolve and unflinching tenacity of the women is unmatched among the Nunnehi. They are very straightforward and speak only when there is something important to say, preferring to act rather than engage in trivial pleasantries.

Young rock giants can be playful and delight in using their rock-like appearance and the natural surroundings to confuse or startle hikers or explorers. They can also be very dangerous, and are always spoiling for a fight. Their appetite for food and violence is enormous and rarely sated. Even those who are in their Summer aspect are always spoiling for a fight, and those under Winter's influence can become ravening butchers. Elders are more sedentary. They spend much of their time in quiet contemplation, and sometimes do not move for days. However, when roused, an elder can be truly fearsome.

Rock giants most commonly manifest amongst the Northeastern tribes: Iroquois, Mohawk, and Seneca. They tend to live among their mortal kin, often on reservations, though some prefer the lofty solitude of the mountains.

They are huge and troll-like in form, encased in flinty rock armor that covers them from head to toe. Their hair is spiky and craggy, resembling stalactites, and their eyes are deep pools of inky black. When sitting or curled up, they can easily be mistaken for large boulders. They often carry flint hatchets or war clubs.

Affinity: Nature

BIRCHRIGHTS

Flint Coat — Rock giants have skin composed of rock that protects them from harm. They are completely impervious to all stone weapons, and have an additional Bruised health level.

Prowess — All rock giants gain an additional dot of Strength, even if this raises them above 5. Also, they can never botch Brawl or Intimidation rolls.

FRAILTIES

Fury — If a rock giant's bravery or physical prowess is ever called into question, the player must immediately spend a point of Willpower or the rock giant assumes her Winter aspect. Once this change occurs, there is no turning back. If the offending party apologizes or tries to run, the rock giant still pursues him until at least a single blow is struck. Until his fury is satisfied, the rock giant can think of nothing else and will singlemindedly hunt the offender. Once a blow is struck, the rock giant can once more assume her Summer aspect.

"Welcome friend. Let us fight, then we shall feast!"

SUREMS

Yaqui stories speak of quiet and helpful "little people" who brought peace wherever they came. Today, they are known as the peacemakers among the Nunnehi. Some Nunnehi even see their actions as traitorous, since they do not actively oppose the European changelings and instead counsel peace.

Surems are attentive listeners. They dislike loud noise and boisterous talking, and oppose violence of any kind. This passivity is sometimes mistaken for weakness, but it comes from their assurance of their spiritual health and the righteousness of their vision. They are overwhelmingly Summer people and consider those who fall into a Winter Camp to be insane. This is not to say that they have never fought. They claim to be the ones who warned the tribes of the coming of the white people. Their close ties with the spirits afforded them the chance to leave as the last roads to the Higher Hunting Grounds closed. However, many chose to stay, and helped to fight against the invaders. This was their last fight, however, and cost them and the tribes dearly, so they chose not to fight again.

Surems can usually be found in the southwestern states of Arizona, Nevada, and southern California, as well as in northwestern Mexico. Unlike other Nunnehi, the majority of the surems live and work alongside human tribespeople, and are often fully-integrated members of the community.